

Reading Reflection 02

When reading this text, I kind of thought this reading would be about architecture hyperspecifically, but a lot of what Schön talks about felt like my everyday process. I work in UX design and of course I am a CART student, so I felt I could relate to his ideas and workflows. Schön's big point is that there's no straight line from your idea to the final result. You try something, the work "responds", and you adjust. That's pretty much what designing interfaces is like for me.

"knowing in action" stood out to me because it's just all the stuff I do without thinking, like walking. In UX, that's exactly what I design around. People already have habits for how buttons, links and menus should behave, and when a design respects that, the interface just kind of disappears. Schön talked about a pen, you don't notice the pen until it runs out of ink. That's why I don't think design is only about how things look. It's about how they work too. When there's too much "innovation" and people can't tell how something is supposed to react, that's when friction shows up.

Schön also warns about "falling in love with an initial design idea." Honestly, that's rarely my problem. I'm pretty critical of my own work, and after so many rounds of critiques and rework, I never assume my first idea ends up being the final product. I always make a bunch of iterations. I think that ties into what he calls the designer's "gyroscope," being able to look at your own stuff and know it's not there yet.

That's also why his idea of backtalk really clicked for me. The Scotch Tape and Growltiger stories show that you don't fully know what you've made until people use it and surprise you. This is why design is kind of "alive", you continuously work on a product because there are always gaps in what we create, which is what makes design beautiful.